

Cisco Systems, Inc. is a **Large Public** firm that is based in **San Jose, California**. They perform **enterprise networking infrastructure and cybersecurity development** for **global commercial corporations, telecommunications providers, and public sector networks**. They are a **publicly traded technology corporation**. This firm offers a potential partnership because their **heavy development in AI-native network routing, data center switching, and automated security systems** aligns directly with UNC's strengths in **software engineering, applied data science, and secure informatics infrastructure**. **Chuck Robbins** is the best avenue for partnership because he **serves as Chairman and Chief Executive Officer of Cisco and is a distinguished computer science mathematics alumnus of UNC-Chapel Hill, maintaining direct institutional ties to the local campus ecosystem**.

Basic Company Information

- **Name, Company Location:** Cisco Systems, Inc., San Jose, CA
- **Company website URL:** cisco.com
- **Company Type, Company Size:** Public, Large (Approx. 82,200 employees)

Company Type

- **IPO?** Yes (NASDAQ: CSCO) 1990

Company Size

- **Small:** 0-100
- **Mid:** 100 - 749
- **Large:** 750+ (Specifically 82,200 post-restructuring)

UNC Connection (if any)

- **UNC Alum (in decision-making position):** Chuck Robbins (Chairman and Chief Executive Officer; earned a Bachelor of Mathematics with a computer science concentration from UNC-Chapel Hill in 1987).
- **Donation History:** Specific institutional financial donation history to UNC is not publicly indexed. Cisco anchors a prominent 5,000-employee campus footprint in North Carolina's Research Triangle Park, supplying regional engineering talent pipelines.

Talking Points

- **Strategic Headcount Realignment:** Cisco announced restructuring plans in May 2026 to reduce its workforce by fewer than 4,000 positions, representing less than 5 percent of its entire global employee base.
- **Elevated Revenue Projections:** The company increased its fiscal year 2026 revenue guidance to a target range of \$62.8 billion to \$63.0 billion, climbing from its \$56.65 billion revenue output in fiscal year 2025.
- **Surging Data Center Demand:** Corporate data center switching orders expanded by more than 40 percent year-over-year in the third quarter of fiscal year 2026, fueled by industrial enterprise artificial intelligence hardware deployment.

- **Acquisition-Driven Security Growth:** The firm's corporate security division expanded by 59.5 percent year-over-year to reach \$8.094 billion, reflecting full integration of its \$28 billion acquisition of Splunk.
- **Aggressive Innovation Spending:** Cisco boosted its total research and development spending to a record metric of \$9.300 billion, consuming 16.4 percent of total operational revenue to scale AI-native computing architectures.

References

- Cisco Investor Relations. (2026, May 13). Cisco reports third quarter earnings. Cisco Systems Inc. Financials. <https://investor.cisco.com/financials/quarterly-results/default.aspx>
- Quantumrun. (2026, May 6). Cisco Statistics 2026. Quantumrun Consulting Reports. <https://www.quantumrun.com/consulting/cisco-statistics/>
- Wikipedia. (2026). Chuck Robbins Profile. Wikipedia Foundation. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chuck_Robbins
- Morris, I. (2026, May 14). Cisco plan to cut 4,000 jobs is not a sign of AI takeover. Light Reading. <https://www.lightreading.com/ai-machine-learning/cisco-plan-to-cut-4-000-jobs-is-not-a-sign-of-ai-takeover>
- India Today. (2026, May 14). Cisco lays off 4,000 employees. India Today Tech Jobs. <https://www.indiatoday.in/jobs/story/cisco-lays-off-4000-employees-ceo-says-must-take-hard-decisions-in-ai-era-tchc-2911446-2026-05-14>